

DAEMONCORE

FieldOps Real World Casebook

Ten authorization-bound scenarios for assessment, resilience, evidence, incident support, and professional reporting.

OPERATOR EDITION

Release 6.5.1
Windows and Linux
DaemonCore Apps
September 2026

TRAINING AND AUTHORIZED PROFESSIONAL USE

The scenarios are fictional. Use only facilitator-assigned lab systems or targets covered by valid written authorization. A FieldOps license does not authorize testing.

Operate the case rather than hunt for an answer

Each case begins with an incomplete but realistic client brief. Your task is to convert that brief into a lawful, testable plan; collect the smallest reliable body of evidence; respond to new information; and deliver a conclusion another professional can review.

- **Run it live.** Use facilitator-assigned lab targets and the current FieldOps desktop application.
- **Run it tabletop.** A facilitator can provide staged results while the operator records decisions and evidence requirements.
- **Do not read ahead.** Reveal injects only at the stated time or after the preceding decision is recorded.
- **Show your work.** Scores reward boundary control, evidence, reasoning, recovery, and reporting - not activity volume.
- **Keep solutions separate.** This operator edition intentionally excludes answer keys and expected findings.

Standard case flow

PHASE	OPERATOR ACTION	EVIDENCE
Brief	Identify authority, objective, uncertainty, and pressure	Initial decision log
Permit	Translate written scope into exact FieldOps boundaries	Signed permit
Preflight	Verify identity, time, destination, tools, observers, and stops	Go or no-go record
Execute	Use the least invasive operation that can answer the question	Sealed captures and receipts
Inject	Respond without stretching scope or rewriting history	Decision and escalation record
Deliver	State observation, inference, limitation, impact, and next action	Report and case export

What passing performance looks like

DOMAIN	PASSING BEHAVIOR	FAILURE PATTERN
Authorization	Exact current boundary and retrievable authority	Assumed or verbally expanded scope
Method	Minimum sufficient diagnostic or workload	Activity without a defined proof point
Evidence	Original source, context, time, digest, and linkage	Screenshots or claims without provenance
Reasoning	Observation separated from inference and limitation	Scanner output copied as a conclusion
Control	Stop criteria honored and recovery verified	Momentum overrides uncertainty
Communication	Clear decision, confidence, impact, and next action	Certainty or severity unsupported by evidence

Scoring bands

SCORE	MEANING
90 to 100	Lead-ready: defensible decisions, complete chain, concise client communication
80 to 89	Operator-ready: sound work with minor evidence or communication gaps
70 to 79	Developing: outcome may be useful but supervision remains necessary
Below 70	Repeat required: material boundary, evidence, reasoning, or control failure

Assessment rule. Critical override. A material authorization breach, ignored stop order, fabricated evidence, or deliberate integrity bypass results in an automatic non-pass regardless of points.

Ten engagements that test different kinds of judgment

CASE	ENGAGEMENT	PRIMARY CAPABILITY	LEVEL
01	Shadow Port	External attack surface drift after an emergency deployment	Foundation
02	Launch Day	API degradation during a planned traffic event	Intermediate
03	Broken Chain	TLS identity failure after certificate renewal	Foundation
04	Branchline	Multi-site network control consistency review	Intermediate
05	New Blood	Post-acquisition perimeter review with incomplete records	Advanced
06	Redline	Production outage triage under conflicting signals	Advanced
07	Silent Alarm	Blue-team visibility validation during controlled activity	Intermediate
08	Unknown Edge	Emergency investigation of a reported internet exposure	Advanced
09	Closing Proof	Remediation verification without breaking intended service	Intermediate
10	Glasshouse	Full external assessment capstone	Capstone

Recommended route. Complete Cases 01 and 03 first, then 02, 04, 07, and 09. Attempt Cases 05, 06, and 08 under time pressure. Use Case 10 as a closed-book capstone.

Shadow Port

External attack surface drift after an emergency deployment

CLIENT	ROLE	DIFFICULTY	TIME	POLICY
Northstar Benefits	External assessor	Foundation	60 to 90 minutes	Validate

Client brief

Northstar's infrastructure team completed an emergency customer-portal deployment overnight. A monitoring analyst now sees a service on a port that is not present in the approved architecture record. The release team says the exposure is temporary; the system owner wants a defensible answer before the morning change meeting.

Operational pressure

The change manager wants a verbal answer in twenty minutes and suggests scanning adjacent ports to save time.

Your first decision

Before touching the target, write what must be true for a go decision, what is still ambiguous, and who can resolve each ambiguity.

Go or no go: _____

Unresolved authority question: _____

First proof point: _____

Translate the brief into a signed boundary

BOUNDARY FIELD	EXERCISE AUTHORITY
Targets	Facilitator-assigned portal hostname and pinned lab address
Ports	443 and one facilitator-assigned candidate port
Window	Current exercise window only
Excluded	Adjacent hosts, credentials, exploitation, configuration changes
Stop	Ownership mismatch, DNS drift, monitoring loss, or client stop

Permit worksheet

Operator: _____

Approving authority: _____

Authorization reference: _____

Exact targets: _____

Exact ports and paths: _____

Valid from and until: _____

Local stop owner: _____

Target-side stop owner: _____

Boundary rule. Do not add a discovered host, port, path, technique, or date to the permit unless the facilitator provides a written amendment.

Objectives and available material

Objectives

- Confirm the authorization boundary before any diagnostic.
- Establish a current surface baseline and compare it with available prior evidence.
- Determine what can be stated about the unexpected service without overstating the evidence.
- Create a finding or documented non-finding with a reproducible evidence trail.
- Define a minimal remediation retest.

Starting artifacts

- Approved target and port list
- Prior architecture extract
- Overnight change ticket summary
- Current DNS response
- Blank client finding template

Plan before execution

SEQUENCE	QUESTION	FIELDOPS WORKSPACE	STOP OR SUCCESS CONDITION
1			
2			
3			
4			
5			

Timed injects and decision gates

The facilitator reveals each inject at the stated exercise time. Record the decision before continuing. The inject changes context; it does not silently change authorization.

TIME	INJECT	REQUIRED DECISION
T plus 10	DNS returns an additional address not mentioned in the briefing.	Decide whether execution may continue and record why.
T plus 25	The release engineer says the port belongs to a temporary admin service.	Separate testimony from observed evidence.
T plus 40	The service stops responding before the review is complete.	Preserve the transient evidence and design the retest.

Decision record

Inject received: _____

Observed facts: _____

Decision: _____

Authority consulted: _____

Evidence preserved: _____

Effect on plan: _____

Evidence map and operator notes

REQUIRED EVIDENCE	CAPTURE OR RECEIPT ID	WHAT IT PROVES	LIMITATION
Permit status and scope strip			
DNS and resolution record			
Allowed-port or complete surface capture			
Service identity evidence			
Prior-versus-current comparison			
Decision and limitation note			

Working conclusion

Observed: _____

Inferred: _____

Confidence: _____

Alternative explanation: _____

Evidence gap: _____

Next highest-information action: _____

Client deliverable and scoring record

Required deliverable

One-page exposure decision, supporting capture list, finding disposition, and remediation retest plan.

Scoring rubric

DOMAIN	POINTS	AWARDED	REVIEWER NOTE
Boundary control	20		
Diagnostic selection	15		
Evidence integrity	20		
Reasoning and limitations	20		
Finding quality	15		
Retest plan	10		

After action review

Best decision: _____

Weakest evidence: _____

Assumption that changed: _____

Stop decision: _____

What I would repeat: _____

What I would change: _____

Launch Day

API degradation during a planned traffic event

CLIENT	ROLE	DIFFICULTY	TIME	POLICY
Atlas Ticketing	Resilience operator	Intermediate	90 to 120 minutes	Stress

Client brief

Atlas expects a large on-sale event tomorrow. The application team increased API capacity but has never measured the new breakpoint or recovery time. The owner has approved a controlled test against a dedicated production-like endpoint and will publish the target-hosted capacity grant.

Operational pressure

Leadership asks for the highest possible request rate and wants the run repeated immediately if the first result is unclear.

Your first decision

Before touching the target, write what must be true for a go decision, what is still ambiguous, and who can resolve each ambiguity.

Go or no go: _____

Unresolved authority question: _____

First proof point: _____

Translate the brief into a signed boundary

BOUNDARY FIELD	EXERCISE AUTHORITY
Target	Facilitator-assigned HTTPS API endpoint
Path	Assigned synthetic health or catalog path
Method	Managed k6 HTTP GET profile only
Capacity	Exactly the verified target-hosted grant
Excluded	Authentication, purchase submission, destructive data, ungranted workers

Permit worksheet

Operator: _____

Approving authority: _____

Authorization reference: _____

Exact targets: _____

Exact ports and paths: _____

Valid from and until: _____

Local stop owner: _____

Target-side stop owner: _____

Boundary rule. Do not add a discovered host, port, path, technique, or date to the permit unless the facilitator provides a written amendment.

Objectives and available material

Objectives

- Capture a clean baseline before pressure.
- Verify the challenge-bound capacity grant and select an appropriate profile.
- Correlate achieved RPS, p95 latency, errors, dropped iterations, and target saturation.
- Apply the agreed stop criteria without waiting for total failure.
- Prove recovery and produce a capacity conclusion that distinguishes target limits from generator limits.

Starting artifacts

- Rules of engagement
- Capacity grant JSON
- Service SLO
- Target monitoring snapshot
- Change calendar
- Recovery-owner contact card

Plan before execution

SEQUENCE	QUESTION	FIELDOPS WORKSPACE	STOP OR SUCCESS CONDITION
1			
2			
3			
4			
5			

Timed injects and decision gates

The facilitator reveals each inject at the stated exercise time. Record the decision before continuing. The inject changes context; it does not silently change authorization.

TIME	INJECT	REQUIRED DECISION
T plus 15	The grant expires sooner than the planned workload would finish.	Resolve the mismatch before arming.
T plus 35	P95 rises while error rate remains low and a queue approaches saturation.	Decide whether the abort threshold or proof point has been reached.
T plus 55	Traffic ends but queue depth does not return to baseline.	Continue recovery observation and avoid premature success.

Decision record

Inject received: _____

Observed facts: _____

Decision: _____

Authority consulted: _____

Evidence preserved: _____

Effect on plan: _____

Evidence map and operator notes

REQUIRED EVIDENCE	CAPTURE OR RECEIPT ID	WHAT IT PROVES	LIMITATION
Baseline capture			
Verified grant digest			
Signed workload plan			
k6 engine version			
Live telemetry summary			
Stop reason			
Recovery proof			

Working conclusion

Observed: _____

Inferred: _____

Confidence: _____

Alternative explanation: _____

Evidence gap: _____

Next highest-information action: _____

Client deliverable and scoring record

Required deliverable

Capacity and recovery report stating the tested envelope, first degradation signal, stop decision, recovery time, and next safe experiment.

Scoring rubric

DOMAIN	POINTS	AWARDED	REVIEWER NOTE
Grant verification	20		
Profile design	15		
Telemetry interpretation	25		
Stop discipline	15		
Recovery proof	15		
Report precision	10		

After action review

Best decision: _____

Weakest evidence: _____

Assumption that changed: _____

Stop decision: _____

What I would repeat: _____

What I would change: _____

Broken Chain

TLS identity failure after certificate renewal

CLIENT	ROLE	DIFFICULTY	TIME	POLICY
Meridian Health Logistics	Application security assessor	Foundation	60 to 90 minutes	Observe

Client brief

A partner integration began rejecting one regional endpoint after a certificate renewal. Browser users report mixed results. Operations believes the certificate is valid because the primary endpoint works. The client needs to know whether the failure is identity, chain, protocol, load-balancer, or client-specific behavior.

Operational pressure

A manager asks the operator to ignore hostname validation temporarily so the partner can reconnect.

Your first decision

Before touching the target, write what must be true for a go decision, what is still ambiguous, and who can resolve each ambiguity.

Go or no go: _____

Unresolved authority question: _____

First proof point: _____

Translate the brief into a signed boundary

BOUNDARY FIELD	EXERCISE AUTHORITY
Targets	Two facilitator-assigned regional hostnames
Ports	443 only
Permitted	DNS, TCP, TLS identity, and HTTP response evidence
Excluded	Certificate changes, authentication, private keys, bypass advice
Stop	Unexpected ownership or resolution outside assigned boundary

Permit worksheet

Operator: _____

Approving authority: _____

Authorization reference: _____

Exact targets: _____

Exact ports and paths: _____

Valid from and until: _____

Local stop owner: _____

Target-side stop owner: _____

Boundary rule. Do not add a discovered host, port, path, technique, or date to the permit unless the facilitator provides a written amendment.

Objectives and available material

Objectives

- Compare name resolution and pinned destinations for both endpoints.
- Capture certificate identity, protocol, and chain-relevant evidence.
- Distinguish observed facts from client compatibility hypotheses.
- Identify the minimum corrective control and a safe validation sequence.
- Document residual uncertainty where FieldOps evidence is insufficient.

Starting artifacts

- Partner error excerpt
- Renewal change record
- Expected hostnames
- Regional load-balancer inventory
- Approved maintenance window

Plan before execution

SEQUENCE	QUESTION	FIELDOPS WORKSPACE	STOP OR SUCCESS CONDITION
1			
2			
3			
4			
5			

Timed injects and decision gates

The facilitator reveals each inject at the stated exercise time. Record the decision before continuing. The inject changes context; it does not silently change authorization.

TIME	INJECT	REQUIRED DECISION
T plus 15	One hostname alternates between two addresses.	Capture resolution and avoid assuming equivalent configuration.
T plus 30	The certificate dates are valid but the identity differs on one address.	Describe the failed control precisely.
T plus 45	Operations proposes disabling validation at the client.	Recommend a control-preserving response.

Decision record

Inject received: _____

Observed facts: _____

Decision: _____

Authority consulted: _____

Evidence preserved: _____

Effect on plan: _____

Evidence map and operator notes

REQUIRED EVIDENCE	CAPTURE OR RECEIPT ID	WHAT IT PROVES	LIMITATION
DNS records			
TCP reachability			
TLS identity per pinned destination			
HTTP response metadata			
Comparison note			
Retest checklist			

Working conclusion

Observed: _____

Inferred: _____

Confidence: _____

Alternative explanation: _____

Evidence gap: _____

Next highest-information action: _____

Client deliverable and scoring record

Required deliverable

TLS incident brief with affected path, observed identity, likely control failure, immediate containment recommendation, and retest criteria.

Scoring rubric

DOMAIN	POINTS	AWARDED	REVIEWER NOTE
Comparative method	20		
TLS evidence	20		
Root-cause reasoning	20		
Control-preserving advice	20		
Retest quality	10		
Communication	10		

After action review

Best decision: _____

Weakest evidence: _____

Assumption that changed: _____

Stop decision: _____

What I would repeat: _____

What I would change: _____

Branchline

Multi-site network control consistency review

CLIENT	ROLE	DIFFICULTY	TIME	POLICY
Redwood Manufacturing	Network security consultant	Intermediate	90 to 120 minutes	Validate

Client brief

Redwood operates four plants that should share a common remote-access and management baseline. An audit found inconsistent firewall documentation. The client wants evidence of externally observable consistency before a wider remediation program begins.

Operational pressure

The network lead says a timeout should be counted as secure and asks for a green summary by site.

Your first decision

Before touching the target, write what must be true for a go decision, what is still ambiguous, and who can resolve each ambiguity.

Go or no go: _____

Unresolved authority question: _____

First proof point: _____

Translate the brief into a signed boundary

BOUNDARY FIELD	EXERCISE AUTHORITY
Targets	Four facilitator-assigned site endpoints
Ports	Exact facilitator-assigned management and web ports
Permitted	Campaign DNS, inventory, service, TLS, and posture checks
Excluded	Credential testing, exploitation, unlisted ranges
Stop	Systematic timeout, DNS drift, rate limiting, or site-owner request

Permit worksheet

Operator: _____

Approving authority: _____

Authorization reference: _____

Exact targets: _____

Exact ports and paths: _____

Valid from and until: _____

Local stop owner: _____

Target-side stop owner: _____

Boundary rule. Do not add a discovered host, port, path, technique, or date to the permit unless the facilitator provides a written amendment.

Objectives and available material

Objectives

- Create a campaign that answers one consistent control question.
- Differentiate closed, filtered, unreachable, and unobserved states.
- Identify material outliers without treating every difference as a vulnerability.
- Preserve site-specific evidence and campaign-level reasoning.
- Prioritize remediation by control risk and business context.

Starting artifacts

- Expected site standard
- Plant criticality table
- Approved targets and ports
- Network-owner roster
- Known maintenance exceptions

Plan before execution

SEQUENCE	QUESTION	FIELDOPS WORKSPACE	STOP OR SUCCESS CONDITION
1			
2			
3			
4			
5			

Timed injects and decision gates

The facilitator reveals each inject at the stated exercise time. Record the decision before continuing. The inject changes context; it does not silently change authorization.

TIME	INJECT	REQUIRED DECISION
T plus 20	One site returns widespread timeouts after several completed tasks.	Pause or continue based on evidence and communications.
T plus 40	A site owner identifies an approved exception absent from the initial brief.	Treat the exception as new context, not retroactive proof.
T plus 60	Two services share a version string but expose different posture.	Avoid version-only conclusions.

Decision record

Inject received: _____

Observed facts: _____

Decision: _____

Authority consulted: _____

Evidence preserved: _____

Effect on plan: _____

Evidence map and operator notes

REQUIRED EVIDENCE	CAPTURE OR RECEIPT ID	WHAT IT PROVES	LIMITATION
Campaign definition			
Per-target task ledger			
Service and posture captures			
Exception record			
Outlier matrix			
Campaign stop or resume decision			

Working conclusion

Observed: _____

Inferred: _____

Confidence: _____

Alternative explanation: _____

Evidence gap: _____

Next highest-information action: _____

Client deliverable and scoring record

Required deliverable

Four-site consistency matrix, prioritized exceptions, evidence map, and recommended validation sequence.

Scoring rubric

DOMAIN	POINTS	AWARDED	REVIEWER NOTE
Campaign design	20		
State interpretation	20		
Outlier analysis	20		
Exception handling	15		
Evidence mapping	15		
Prioritization	10		

After action review

Best decision: _____

Weakest evidence: _____

Assumption that changed: _____

Stop decision: _____

What I would repeat: _____

What I would change: _____

New Blood

Post-acquisition perimeter review with incomplete records

CLIENT	ROLE	DIFFICULTY	TIME	POLICY
Kestrel Financial Group	Integration security assessor	Advanced	120 minutes	Validate

Client brief

Kestrel acquired a small software company. The seller provided partial infrastructure records, and several services are operated by third parties. The integration team needs a defensible starting inventory without testing assets that the acquired company does not control.

Operational pressure

The deal team provides a broad brand domain and says anything related to the name is probably in scope.

Your first decision

Before touching the target, write what must be true for a go decision, what is still ambiguous, and who can resolve each ambiguity.

Go or no go: _____

Unresolved authority question: _____

First proof point: _____

Translate the brief into a signed boundary

BOUNDARY FIELD	EXERCISE AUTHORITY
Targets	Only facilitator-confirmed exact hostnames
Ports	Only listed service ports
Permitted	Ownership validation, surface baseline, service inventory, posture
Excluded	Related domains, third-party SaaS, discovered hosts, credentials
Stop	Ownership ambiguity, third-party indicators, or boundary mismatch

Permit worksheet

Operator: _____

Approving authority: _____

Authorization reference: _____

Exact targets: _____

Exact ports and paths: _____

Valid from and until: _____

Local stop owner: _____

Target-side stop owner: _____

Boundary rule. Do not add a discovered host, port, path, technique, or date to the permit unless the facilitator provides a written amendment.

Objectives and available material

Objectives

- Convert incomplete records into exact testable scope without inference-based expansion.
- Establish an initial asset and service baseline.
- Track ownership confidence separately from technical observation.
- Identify evidence gaps that block a security conclusion.
- Produce an integration backlog ordered by ownership and exposure risk.

Starting artifacts

- Partial asset spreadsheet
- Domain registration excerpt
- Vendor list
- Acquisition contact tree
- Approved exact-target addendum

Plan before execution

SEQUENCE	QUESTION	FIELDOPS WORKSPACE	STOP OR SUCCESS CONDITION
1			
2			
3			
4			
5			

Timed injects and decision gates

The facilitator reveals each inject at the stated exercise time. Record the decision before continuing. The inject changes context; it does not silently change authorization.

TIME	INJECT	REQUIRED DECISION
T plus 20	A discovered hostname appears branded but resolves to a major SaaS provider.	Exclude it until authority is confirmed.
T plus 45	The seller's engineer claims ownership but cannot provide a contract or account record.	Record confidence and escalate authority verification.
T plus 70	A known asset exposes a service absent from all records.	Validate only within declared ports and record the inventory gap.

Decision record

Inject received: _____

Observed facts: _____

Decision: _____

Authority consulted: _____

Evidence preserved: _____

Effect on plan: _____

Evidence map and operator notes

REQUIRED EVIDENCE	CAPTURE OR RECEIPT ID	WHAT IT PROVES	LIMITATION
Authorization addendum			
Ownership-confidence ledger			
Surface baselines			
Service inventory			
Third-party exclusions			
Evidence-gap register			

Working conclusion

Observed: _____

Inferred: _____

Confidence: _____

Alternative explanation: _____

Evidence gap: _____

Next highest-information action: _____

Client deliverable and scoring record

Required deliverable

Acquisition perimeter baseline, ownership-confidence matrix, excluded-asset log, and prioritized integration backlog.

Scoring rubric

DOMAIN	POINTS	AWARDED	REVIEWER NOTE
Scope discipline	25		
Ownership reasoning	20		
Inventory quality	20		
Gap management	15		
Risk prioritization	10		
Record clarity	10		

After action review

Best decision: _____

Weakest evidence: _____

Assumption that changed: _____

Stop decision: _____

What I would repeat: _____

What I would change: _____

Redline

Production outage triage under conflicting signals

CLIENT	ROLE	DIFFICULTY	TIME	POLICY
Harbor Freight Systems	Incident support operator	Advanced	90 minutes	Observe

Client brief

Customers intermittently fail to reach a shipping-status application. Internal dashboards show healthy application instances, while support reports regional failures. FieldOps is authorized for focused external diagnostics only; the incident commander owns all production changes.

Operational pressure

Several teams offer competing explanations and ask the operator to prove one quickly.

Your first decision

Before touching the target, write what must be true for a go decision, what is still ambiguous, and who can resolve each ambiguity.

Go or no go: _____

Unresolved authority question: _____

First proof point: _____

Translate the brief into a signed boundary

BOUNDARY FIELD	EXERCISE AUTHORITY
Target	Facilitator-assigned public application hostname
Ports	443 only
Permitted	DNS, TCP, TLS, HTTP, and repeated bounded baseline evidence
Excluded	Load generation, configuration changes, internal systems
Stop	Incident commander request, ownership drift, or material user impact

Permit worksheet

Operator: _____

Approving authority: _____

Authorization reference: _____

Exact targets: _____

Exact ports and paths: _____

Valid from and until: _____

Local stop owner: _____

Target-side stop owner: _____

Boundary rule. Do not add a discovered host, port, path, technique, or date to the permit unless the facilitator provides a written amendment.

Objectives and available material

Objectives

- Build a time-aligned external observation sequence.
- Distinguish DNS, reachability, TLS, HTTP, dependency, and saturation hypotheses.
- Communicate what FieldOps can and cannot prove from the assigned vantage point.
- Preserve observations without delaying incident recovery.
- Recommend the next highest-information check to the incident commander.

Starting artifacts

- Incident timeline excerpt
- Regional support reports
- Application dashboard snapshot
- Recent DNS change
- Incident command roles

Plan before execution

SEQUENCE	QUESTION	FIELDOPS WORKSPACE	STOP OR SUCCESS CONDITION
1			
2			
3			
4			
5			

Timed injects and decision gates

The facilitator reveals each inject at the stated exercise time. Record the decision before continuing. The inject changes context; it does not silently change authorization.

TIME	INJECT	REQUIRED DECISION
T plus 10	DNS answers change while the application dashboard stays green.	Align external evidence with the change timeline.
T plus 30	TLS succeeds but HTTP responses alternate between success and gateway error.	Avoid collapsing layers into one cause.
T plus 50	The incident commander restores service before root cause is proven.	Prioritize recovery evidence and preserve uncertainty.

Decision record

Inject received: _____

Observed facts: _____

Decision: _____

Authority consulted: _____

Evidence preserved: _____

Effect on plan: _____

Evidence map and operator notes

REQUIRED EVIDENCE	CAPTURE OR RECEIPT ID	WHAT IT PROVES	LIMITATION
Timestamped resolution series			
Layered diagnostic captures			
Observed-versus-reported matrix			
Decision log			
Recovery confirmation			
Unresolved hypotheses			

Working conclusion

Observed: _____

Inferred: _____

Confidence: _____

Alternative explanation: _____

Evidence gap: _____

Next highest-information action: _____

Client deliverable and scoring record

Required deliverable

Concise incident support timeline, layer-by-layer findings, confidence statement, and recommended follow-up evidence.

Scoring rubric

DOMAIN	POINTS	AWARDED	REVIEWER NOTE
Layered reasoning	25		
Time alignment	20		
Incident discipline	20		
Confidence language	15		
Recovery evidence	10		
Next action	10		

After action review

Best decision: _____

Weakest evidence: _____

Assumption that changed: _____

Stop decision: _____

What I would repeat: _____

What I would change: _____

Silent Alarm

Blue-team visibility validation during controlled activity

CLIENT	ROLE	DIFFICULTY	TIME	POLICY
Crown Peak Energy	Purple-team operator	Intermediate	90 to 120 minutes	Validate

Client brief

Crown Peak recently deployed new network detections. The defensive team wants to validate visibility of approved discovery and service-assessment activity without turning the exercise into an adversary emulation campaign.

Operational pressure

The detection engineer asks for more aggressive behavior after the first activity produces no alert.

Your first decision

Before touching the target, write what must be true for a go decision, what is still ambiguous, and who can resolve each ambiguity.

Go or no go: _____

Unresolved authority question: _____

First proof point: _____

Translate the brief into a signed boundary

BOUNDARY FIELD	EXERCISE AUTHORITY
Targets	Two facilitator-assigned monitored endpoints
Ports	Exact assigned service ports
Permitted	Named diagnostics, managed inventory, one approved campaign
Excluded	Evasion, exploitation, credentials, persistence, unapproved techniques
Stop	Monitoring loss, target health concern, or exercise-control request

Permit worksheet

Operator: _____

Approving authority: _____

Authorization reference: _____

Exact targets: _____

Exact ports and paths: _____

Valid from and until: _____

Local stop owner: _____

Target-side stop owner: _____

Boundary rule. Do not add a discovered host, port, path, technique, or date to the permit unless the facilitator provides a written amendment.

Objectives and available material

Objectives

- Agree on expected telemetry before execution.
- Run a reproducible sequence that defenders can correlate.
- Separate missing telemetry, missing analytic logic, and missing alert routing.
- Change one variable at a time when repeating activity.
- Produce an evidence-backed detection improvement record.

Starting artifacts

- Detection objective
- Expected data-source list
- Exercise communication plan
- Approved operation sequence
- Defender observation worksheet

Plan before execution

SEQUENCE	QUESTION	FIELDOPS WORKSPACE	STOP OR SUCCESS CONDITION
1			
2			
3			
4			
5			

Timed injects and decision gates

The facilitator reveals each inject at the stated exercise time. Record the decision before continuing. The inject changes context; it does not silently change authorization.

TIME	INJECT	REQUIRED DECISION
T plus 15	Endpoint telemetry appears but the network sensor shows nothing.	Determine whether execution or collection changed.
T plus 35	An alert fires ten minutes late with the wrong asset owner.	Record detection, enrichment, and routing separately.
T plus 55	A defender requests an unapproved technique to force an alert.	Hold the boundary and propose an amendment.

Decision record

Inject received: _____

Observed facts: _____

Decision: _____

Authority consulted: _____

Evidence preserved: _____

Effect on plan: _____

Evidence map and operator notes

REQUIRED EVIDENCE	CAPTURE OR RECEIPT ID	WHAT IT PROVES	LIMITATION
Signed permit			
Operation receipts			
Exact execution timeline			
Defender event identifiers			
Expected-versus-observed matrix			
Repeat-test plan			

Working conclusion

Observed: _____

Inferred: _____

Confidence: _____

Alternative explanation: _____

Evidence gap: _____

Next highest-information action: _____

Client deliverable and scoring record

Required deliverable

Detection validation record covering data collection, analytic result, enrichment, routing, timing, and recommended retest.

Scoring rubric

DOMAIN	POINTS	AWARDED	REVIEWER NOTE
Expectation design	15		
Reproducibility	20		
Correlation quality	20		
Gap classification	20		
Scope control	15		
Retest plan	10		

After action review

Best decision: _____

Weakest evidence: _____

Assumption that changed: _____

Stop decision: _____

What I would repeat: _____

What I would change: _____

Unknown Edge

Emergency investigation of a reported internet exposure

CLIENT	ROLE	DIFFICULTY	TIME	POLICY
Orchid Public Services	On-call security assessor	Advanced	75 to 90 minutes	Validate

Client brief

A researcher reports an administrative interface associated with Orchid. The screenshot lacks a reliable timestamp and the hostname is not in the asset inventory. Legal has authorized validation of one exact hostname after the infrastructure owner confirms control.

Operational pressure

Executives want proof before notifying the vendor, while the reporter asks whether Orchid has started testing.

Your first decision

Before touching the target, write what must be true for a go decision, what is still ambiguous, and who can resolve each ambiguity.

Go or no go: _____

Unresolved authority question: _____

First proof point: _____

Translate the brief into a signed boundary

BOUNDARY FIELD	EXERCISE AUTHORITY
Target	Single facilitator-assigned exact hostname
Ports	443 and one assigned administrative port
Permitted	Ownership, DNS, reachability, TLS, HTTP posture, bounded path map
Excluded	Login attempts, credentials, exploit validation, adjacent assets
Stop	Third-party ownership, authentication boundary, or scope drift

Permit worksheet

Operator: _____

Approving authority: _____

Authorization reference: _____

Exact targets: _____

Exact ports and paths: _____

Valid from and until: _____

Local stop owner: _____

Target-side stop owner: _____

Boundary rule. Do not add a discovered host, port, path, technique, or date to the permit unless the facilitator provides a written amendment.

Objectives and available material

Objectives

- Validate authority and ownership before testing.
- Determine whether the reported exposure is currently observable.
- Preserve transient evidence without crossing an authentication boundary.
- Classify the result with appropriate confidence.
- Create a containment and stakeholder communication recommendation.

Starting artifacts

- Researcher report
- Owner confirmation
- Legal authorization note
- Asset inventory excerpt
- Vendor escalation path

Plan before execution

SEQUENC E	QUESTION	FIELDOPS WORKSPACE	STOP OR SUCCESS CONDITION
1			
2			
3			
4			
5			

Timed injects and decision gates

The facilitator reveals each inject at the stated exercise time. Record the decision before continuing. The inject changes context; it does not silently change authorization.

TIME	INJECT	REQUIRED DECISION
T plus 10	The hostname resolves through a content-delivery provider.	Distinguish delivery infrastructure from service ownership.
T plus 30	The assigned path redirects to an authentication page.	Stop at the approved proof point.
T plus 50	The interface disappears after the vendor is contacted.	Preserve before-and-after evidence and avoid claiming remediation cause.

Decision record

Inject received: _____

Observed facts: _____

Decision: _____

Authority consulted: _____

Evidence preserved: _____

Effect on plan: _____

Evidence map and operator notes

REQUIRED EVIDENCE	CAPTURE OR RECEIPT ID	WHAT IT PROVES	LIMITATION
Authority confirmation			
Resolution and TLS identity			
HTTP metadata			
Bounded path result			
Before-and-after captures			
Stakeholder decision log			

Working conclusion

Observed: _____

Inferred: _____

Confidence: _____

Alternative explanation: _____

Evidence gap: _____

Next highest-information action: _____

Client deliverable and scoring record

Required deliverable

Emergency exposure brief with authority trail, observation status, confidence, containment recommendation, and evidence-preservation plan.

Scoring rubric

DOMAIN	POINTS	AWARDED	REVIEWER NOTE
Authority validation	25		
Minimal proof	20		
Transient evidence	20		
Confidence discipline	15		
Containment advice	10		
Communication	10		

After action review

Best decision: _____

Weakest evidence: _____

Assumption that changed: _____

Stop decision: _____

What I would repeat: _____

What I would change: _____

Closing Proof

Remediation verification without breaking intended service

CLIENT	ROLE	DIFFICULTY	TIME	POLICY
Summit Legal Cloud	Independent retest operator	Intermediate	75 minutes	Validate

Client brief

Summit reports that three perimeter findings were remediated: an unnecessary service was removed, a TLS identity issue was corrected, and an HTTP control was added. The operator must independently verify closure while confirming that the intended customer path still works.

Operational pressure

The remediation owner asks the assessor to close all three findings based on screenshots from the change ticket.

Your first decision

Before touching the target, write what must be true for a go decision, what is still ambiguous, and who can resolve each ambiguity.

Go or no go: _____

Unresolved authority question: _____

First proof point: _____

Translate the brief into a signed boundary

BOUNDARY FIELD	EXERCISE AUTHORITY
Targets	Facilitator-assigned application and service hostnames
Ports	Exact original finding ports
Permitted	Minimum original proof plus intended-function checks
Excluded	New broad assessment, adjacent findings, destructive actions
Stop	Target drift, production health issue, or new material exposure

Permit worksheet

Operator: _____

Approving authority: _____

Authorization reference: _____

Exact targets: _____

Exact ports and paths: _____

Valid from and until: _____

Local stop owner: _____

Target-side stop owner: _____

Boundary rule. Do not add a discovered host, port, path, technique, or date to the permit unless the facilitator provides a written amendment.

Objectives and available material

Objectives

- Recover the original proof and its prerequisites.
- Design the minimum independent retest for each finding.
- Verify both security outcome and intended functionality.
- Distinguish fixed, partially fixed, not fixed, and unable to verify.
- Attach new sealed evidence and update disposition with clear rationale.

Starting artifacts

- Original findings
- Original capture digests
- Remediation statements
- Change-window record
- Expected service behavior

Plan before execution

SEQUENCE	QUESTION	FIELDOPS WORKSPACE	STOP OR SUCCESS CONDITION
1			
2			
3			
4			
5			

Timed injects and decision gates

The facilitator reveals each inject at the stated exercise time. Record the decision before continuing. The inject changes context; it does not silently change authorization.

TIME	INJECT	REQUIRED DECISION
T plus 15	The service is no longer reachable, but intended business ownership is unclear.	Do not equate outage with remediation.
T plus 30	TLS identity is correct on one resolved address but not another.	Retest the complete authorized path.
T plus 45	The HTTP control appears only on successful responses.	Assess relevant response classes within scope.

Decision record

Inject received: _____

Observed facts: _____

Decision: _____

Authority consulted: _____

Evidence preserved: _____

Effect on plan: _____

Evidence map and operator notes

REQUIRED EVIDENCE	CAPTURE OR RECEIPT ID	WHAT IT PROVES	LIMITATION
Original evidence linkage			
New independent captures			
Resolution set			
Expected-function evidence			
Before-and-after comparison			
Disposition history			

Working conclusion

Observed: _____

Inferred: _____

Confidence: _____

Alternative explanation: _____

Evidence gap: _____

Next highest-information action: _____

Client deliverable and scoring record

Required deliverable

Retest memorandum for all three findings with verdict, supporting evidence, residual risk, and next action.

Scoring rubric

DOMAIN	POINTS	AWARDED	REVIEWER NOTE
Original-proof recovery	15		
Retest design	20		
Functional validation	20		
Verdict accuracy	20		
Evidence linkage	15		
Residual-risk statement	10		

After action review

Best decision: _____

Weakest evidence: _____

Assumption that changed: _____

Stop decision: _____

What I would repeat: _____

What I would change: _____

Glasshouse

Full external assessment capstone

CLIENT	ROLE	DIFFICULTY	TIME	POLICY
Asterion Commerce	Lead FieldOps operator	Capstone	180 to 240 minutes	Stress

Client brief

Asterion is preparing a customer-platform release. The operator receives a signed rules-of-engagement packet covering an application endpoint, a service endpoint, a controlled resilience path, and a limited test window. The engagement must produce an executive-ready report and a machine-verifiable case export.

Operational pressure

The client changes priorities during execution, a target behaves differently from the architecture record, and the release decision depends on the operator's confidence statement.

Your first decision

Before touching the target, write what must be true for a go decision, what is still ambiguous, and who can resolve each ambiguity.

Go or no go: _____

Unresolved authority question: _____

First proof point: _____

Translate the brief into a signed boundary

BOUNDARY FIELD	EXERCISE AUTHORITY
Targets	Facilitator-assigned application and service endpoints
Ports	Exact ports in the exercise permit
Permitted	Diagnostics, campaign, managed inventory, verified load, findings, retest
Excluded	Credentials, exploitation, persistence, destructive changes, unlisted assets
Stop	Any permit, grant, health, monitoring, ownership, or communications failure

Permit worksheet

Operator: _____

Approving authority: _____

Authorization reference: _____

Exact targets: _____

Exact ports and paths: _____

Valid from and until: _____

Local stop owner: _____

Target-side stop owner: _____

Boundary rule. Do not add a discovered host, port, path, technique, or date to the permit unless the facilitator provides a written amendment.

Objectives and available material

Objectives

- Create and verify the complete signed engagement boundary.
- Build an evidence-led assessment plan and adapt it as injects arrive.
- Establish surface, service, posture, and resilience evidence.
- Manage a stop decision and demonstrate recovery.
- Produce prioritized findings, a retest plan, a professional report, and a complete case file.

Starting artifacts

- Rules of engagement
- Architecture summary
- Target-hosted capacity grant
- SLO and stop matrix
- Prior finding excerpt
- Executive reporting template

Plan before execution

SEQUENCE	QUESTION	FIELDOPS WORKSPACE	STOP OR SUCCESS CONDITION
1			
2			
3			
4			
5			

Timed injects and decision gates

The facilitator reveals each inject at the stated exercise time. Record the decision before continuing. The inject changes context; it does not silently change authorization.

TIME	INJECT	REQUIRED DECISION
T plus 25	One hostname resolves outside the expected provider range.	Pause the affected path and seek a scope decision.
T plus 60	A service fingerprint conflicts with the architecture record.	Validate behavior before escalating the conclusion.
T plus 100	Managed load reaches an abort threshold before the planned peak.	Stop, preserve evidence, and prove recovery.
T plus 130	The client asks to add an unlisted endpoint before the window closes.	Use amendment discipline rather than verbal expansion.
T plus 160	A reported fix is available for immediate retest.	Design the minimum independent retest.

Decision record

Inject received: _____

Observed facts: _____

Decision: _____

Authority consulted: _____

Evidence preserved: _____

Effect on plan: _____

Evidence map and operator notes

REQUIRED EVIDENCE	CAPTURE OR RECEIPT ID	WHAT IT PROVES	LIMITATION
Operator identity and permit			
Preflight record			
Diagnostic and campaign captures			
Managed tool receipts			
Grant and load telemetry			
Stop and recovery record			
Findings and retests			
Report and case export			

Working conclusion

Observed: _____

Inferred: _____

Confidence: _____

Alternative explanation: _____

Evidence gap: _____

Next highest-information action: _____

Client deliverable and scoring record

Required deliverable

Complete engagement package: executive summary, technical findings, evidence index, resilience conclusion, limitations, remediation priorities, retest plan, and exported case file.

Scoring rubric

DOMAIN	POINTS	AWARDED	REVIEWER NOTE
Authorization control	15		
Assessment strategy	15		
Technical evidence	20		
Live decisions	15		
Findings and retest	15		
Report quality	10		
Case integrity	10		

After action review

Best decision: _____

Weakest evidence: _____

Assumption that changed: _____

Stop decision: _____

What I would repeat: _____

What I would change: _____

Casebook operator record

CASE	ATTEMPT DATE	SCORE	REVIEWER	RESULT
01 Shadow Port				
02 Launch Day				
03 Broken Chain				
04 Branchline				
05 New Blood				
06 Redline				
07 Silent Alarm				
08 Unknown Edge				
09 Closing Proof				
10 Glasshouse				

Operator statement

I completed the recorded exercises using assigned lab systems or explicitly authorized targets. The evidence and decisions submitted for review are my own work and accurately represent the exercise record.

Operator name: _____

Operator signature: _____

Date: _____

Reviewer signature: _____

Final result: _____